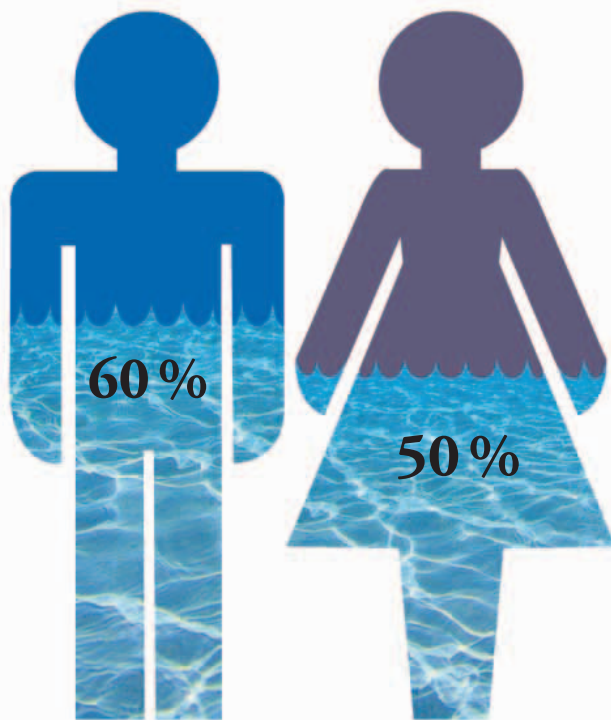


WOW!

Every day your body loses at least 3½ pints (2 liters) of water—enough to fill a big soda bottle!

WATER CONTENT

Up to 74 percent of a baby's body weight is water. As he or she gets older the water content gradually goes down. A young man's body is around 60 percent water, because if he is in good shape he has plenty of water-rich muscle tissue. A young woman's body is less muscular, so it contains less water—about 50 percent. Older people have even less muscle, so water may account for only 40 percent of their total body weight.



WASTE DISPOSAL



DESERT SURVIVAL

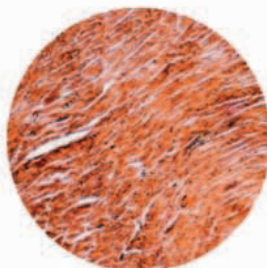
Deserts are places where water is incredibly scarce. Any water on the surface soon dries out, so finding a drink is very difficult. Desert people survive by carrying water with them, but the bodies of desert animals are adapted to cut down their water loss. For example, a camel's body temperature can rise by 11 °F (6 °C) before it starts losing moisture by sweating. This would almost certainly kill a human.

ESSENTIAL FOR LIFE

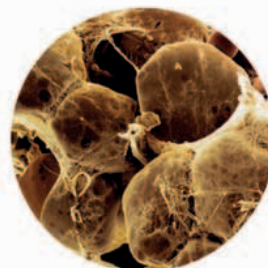
All the chemical reactions that power life take place in the water contained in each of your 100 trillion body cells. Without water, there would be no body chemistry and no life. But some of your body tissues contain more water than others. Muscle has three times as much water as fatty tissue, and vital body fluids, such as your blood, are mostly made up of water.



Blood cells
83% water



Muscle
75% water



Fat
25% water



Bone
22% water